Activity

Setting up a Political Party

Organise groups and ask them to set up political parties that adhere to the rules of the Indian Constitution. Explore the procedure from setting up a party, registering it with the election commission, to contesting in the elections.

7.4. Social, Economic and Political Challenges of Nation Building

The difference between a State and a Nation must first be examined.

The State: A State exists where there is a territory, a people, a government and sovereignty, it may lack the feeling of nationality or of oneness among the people and yet remain a State. The sense of belonging together creates a readiness on the part of the members of a State to subordinate their differences to the common good.

The Nation: The word nation comes from the Latin and when first coined clearly conveyed the idea of common blood ties. It was derived the past participle of the verb nasci meaning to be born, and hence the Latin noun nationem connoting breed or race. The term 'nation' emphasises the consciousness of unity among its people and according to the older view, a nation need not necessarily be a State.

Activity
Think-Pair-Share

Topic: Culture played an important role in creating the idea of the nation in India.

Nationality

The idea of nationality is not easy to define, for there is not one single factor to which it can be traced. It is essentially a sentiment of unity, the resultant of many forces; a community of race and language, geographic unity, a community of religion, common political aspirations, and above all historical development.

He argues that a nation comes into existence only when several elements have come together, especially economic life, language, and territory. According to Ernest Renan, "a nation is a soul, a spiritual principle – only two things constitute this soul: one is in the past; the other is in the present". One is the possession in common of a rich legacy of remembrances, and the other is the actual consent. The desire to live together, the will to continue to value the heritage, which holds in common, contributes to the feeling of nationality.

Challenges

Know-How: The problem was not only increasing production but also reducing disparities. Pandit Jawaharlal Nehru preferred a planned and mixed economy to make India a self-reliant modern nation without compromising its democratic and federal bases. Five years plans ensured plenty of irrigation schemes, institution of basic industries, speedy electrification and extensions of infrastructure facilities India was able to eliminate diseases like malaria, to ensure self-sufficiency in food production, and to evolve and accelerate development of modern science and technologies.

However, during the late 60th and early 70th there were signs of recessions, which lead to political disturbances.

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